FEBRUARY 2007

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot Mountain View, California, built in 1888

THE 1930 CENSUS AS A MOUNTAIN VIEW TIME CAPSULE
Presented by DON McDONALD, Sunday, February 4, 2007 at 2

Don McDonald is the History Editor of the Los Altos History Museum Newsletter. He is often seen at the History Room of the Mountain View Library digging into the history of Los Altos through the records and newspaper articles about Mountain View, Los Altos and unincorporated areas surrounding Mountain View during an earlier period of time.

His presentation will cover the time when the population of Mountain View was slightly above 3,000. He will tell some interesting facts about changes that came about.

The talk may tweak your interest in land development in this area. An exhibit at the Los Altos Museum, telling this story through maps and aerial photos, will give you further information. The exhibit is open until April 15.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE BY ROBERT WEAVER

The New Year is traditionally a time to reflect on the past year and plan for the new one. I would like to take a moment to express my gratitude to the members of the Board, who worked so long and hard last year to keep this association going. Many of these folks have been serving in their positions for years, and I feel honored that many are staying on for my term as well. Thank you, I deeply appreciate your support and guidance.

However, even the most dedicated workers need to rest, and there are no replacements stepping forward to relieve them. This fact brings me to the first goal of my term; getting new members. At the last board meeting we discussed publicizing our programs to attract non-members. This is a small thing, but a big step toward getting new members. One way that you can help is for each of you to invite a family member or neighbor to accompany you to our meetings. We will be doing our part to keep the interest level high by making future programs fresh and interesting. I welcome any suggestions that you may have.

The second goal of my term is the establishment of a history museum/education center at Cuesta Annex. The city council approved a concept plan for the Annex that includes the museum/education center, heritage orchard and open space. We must next obtain from the city council a site plan that formalizes the size and location of the Museum site. Once we have that directive, it is the intent of the museum committee to begin raising funds as soon as possible. We have gained valuable knowledge from Los Altos Historical as to the ways and means of establishing a museum. We will soon be meeting with both Sunnyvale and Palo Alto Historical groups for their insight as well.

It is going to be an exciting year for our association and I look forward to the challenges and rewards that lie ahead.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

75 Years ago (1932):

Public Food Store on Castro Street specials:

Sugar, 10 pounds, 39 cents
Large eggs, 1 dozen, 29 cents
Butter, 1 pound, 29 cents
S&W Coffee, 1 pound, 32 cents.

The first Marines arrived at the new air base. They will furnish security and will act as the ground crew when the dirigible AKRON visits in April. In case of very stormy weather, they will stay in the Redwine warehouse on Dana Street (later remodeled for Cinema Theatre) rather than in tents on base.

The new American Legion Civic Building at Church and Franklin Streets was completed and dedicated.

Post No. 2421: Veterans of Foreign Wars, was organized with 47 charter members. George Cooper will serve as the first commander.

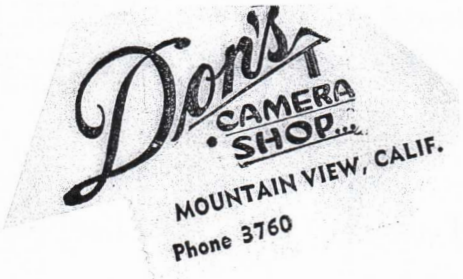
The bicentennial of George Washington's birthday was celebrated with planting of over 40 young redwood trees at the high school, new Legion building and City Park.

Alan Cranston was writing a column, "School Daze," for the high school section in the local newspaper, "Register-Leader."

Formway Machine Shop, on Almond Avenue, began to manufacture small cast metal zeppelins, attached to a mooring mast. They are exact miniatures of the dirigible now being built for the new air base. These toys can be used for radiator ornaments or paper weights.

50 YEARS AGO (1957):

A jet plane coming into Moffett Field crashed in downtown Mountain View, killing the pilot, scattering debris over a large area and starting several fires. The home of Mr. and Mrs. Les Wright, 1093 California Street, at the corner of Oak, sustained the most damage. Mrs. Wright was slightly injured climbing out a window to escape. Don Bellew of Don's Camera Shop on Castro Street, rushed to the crash and his photos were used by United Press all around the world. This accident sparked requests to have all jets moved away from Moffett Field.



Mrs. May Armanini was named 'Citizen of the Year' by the Chamber of Commerce. She was honored for her service to United Community Fund, City Recreation Commission, Girl Scouts, Community Chest, American Red Cross, Pet Parade, Quadalco Club and Parent Teacher Association. Mrs. Armanini, mother of four daughters, graduate of the UC College of Pharmacy, is the wife of Lawrence Armanini and a 25 year resident of Mountain View.

A first for the city -- an official dog catcher with an animal impound truck for transporting animals to the Humane Society in Santa Clara.

Mrs. Edna Lauer Roth retired after nearly 13 years as City Librarian. Age 78, she had previously taught 27 years for the elementary school district.

A Franklin Street site was located for a new library.

Complaints by residents about the noisy, early morning garbage collections led to an order from City Hall to start pick up rounds no earlier than 0600 am. Investigations into contracts and operations revealed that the collectors were saving the profitable, salvageable items for their company instead of delivering everything to the dump. The dump operator, by contract, was to profit from everything which could be sold. In turn, a suit was filed against the City to recover thousands of dollars thought to have been diverted by the garbage collection company.

25 YEARS AGO (1982):

The minimum hourly wage was $3.35.

Over objections by the City Council and many residents, County Supervisors selected a building at 595 E. Middlefield Road, near Highway 237, for a work-furlough jail for minimum-security prisoners.

Mrs. Eva Cooke Kankel celebrated her 100th birthday on February 7th. Mr. and Mrs. Kankel moved to Mountain View from Minnesota in 1927. Of their six sons, three survive Mrs. Kankel, as well as 10 grandchildren, 81 great-grandchildren and three great-great grandchildren.

Mr. Ugo Mancini applied for a patent on a pasta-making machine. He uses a filling made from prosciuto in one of his products, called Ugolini.

Foothill College has published a 180-page book on its history in celebration of 25 years in existence. It started in Mountain View in the former Highway Grammar School on El Camino Real at Calderon with 1,500 students.

Mountain View hopes to deliver to all homes a blend of water from five active wells (hard water) and Hetch-Hetchy water from the Sierras (soft water) in hopes to persuade the 7000-8000 users of water softeners to give up their equipment. Sodium used in the softeners makes wastewater unsuitable for uses such as golf course watering.

STREET TALK BY BARBARA KINCHEN

Thanks to Betty Lamica Evans for information about the street named Marich Way. The Lamica family lived on property at El Monte and El Camino Real and also at the old Junction Inn Hotel structure. Betty remembers a neighbor, Mr. Louis Marich, possibly from Yugoslavia, who took care of the surrounding apricot orchards. As that area was opened for development, apparently a street through the Marich property was named for him.

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER

Given by William and Jean Pawek: booklet by the Paweks, "St. Joseph's Parish, Mountain View, Centennial Scrapbook, Part 1, 1850-1928."

Betty Lamica Evans brought this item over to the Library (someone had given it to her): A small block of wood, 2-2/4" x 1-1/4" x 5/8" thick with a metal chain for keys through a hole at one end. The interesting part is the inscription: "Mountain View High School, 1923 Eagles 1987, original trophy case shelf, your last piece of MVHS." There is also an eagle printed or stamped on the surface.

INCOME AND EXPENSE STATEMENT

Ending Balance as of September 26, 2006: S37,831.12

Income: $ 3,330.60

Expenses: $19,178.45 ($16,000 transferred to CD account)

Balance as of December 14, 2006: $21,983.27

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE OFFICERS

President	Robert Weaver
Vice President	Vivian Schatz
Sergeant at Arms	Craig Holden
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer	Pat Figueroa
Past President	Nick Galiotto
Editor	Trudi Tuban
Membership	June Casey
Memorials & Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Programs & Publicity	Wally Erichsen
Hospitality	Laura Brown
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Al Jehning

MEMBERSHIP REPORT BY JUNE CASEY

Single Members	110	
Family Members	124	
Life Members	124	
Honored Members	2	
TOTAL		360

New A/S Member: Betty O. Mendoza
New Life Members: James N. Porter, Anne Bakotich

Deceased Members: Donald Holt, Dominic Patti, Nancy L. Smith
Roberta Bubb Sweeney

IN MEMORIAM

DONALD MUIRLE HOLT, a native of Mountain View, passed away from a stroke on October 16, 2006. He is survived by his wife of 61 years, Virginia McClaine; sons Ronald Holt and Donald Holt and daughter Donna Hendee. Don was a Mountain View mail carrier from 1941 to 1974. He graduated from Mountain View Union High School in 1937 and was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

ROBERTA BUBB SWEENEY died January 8, 2007. She was from a pioneering family and Past President of the Mountain View Historical Association.
A more extensive obituary will be in our next Newsletter.

We regret that we do not have obituary information for Dominic Patti or Nancy Smith.

EAGLES SHACK

Was the Eagles Shack a real structure? The Eagles Shack seemed to be an imaginary place disguised inside the solid Adobe Building only coming to life on selected Saturday evenings in a town recently founded in a place where eagles have flown for millennia.

Early in the second year, Feb. 1943, of World War II the Adobe building was used as a Service Men's Club. As reported in the MV Register-Leader, "The first order of business undertaken by the city council last night," (Feb. 3, 1943) "when a full board, together with City Clerk E. B. Erichsen and City Attorney Kenneth R. Malovos, was present, was hearing of arrangements made the executive committee recently organized to handle the affairs of the Service Men's Hospitality House and accept its petition for the use of the Adobe Building as a recreation center for service men either stationed or visiting here."[1] Within two weeks support blossomed: Wood was donated for the huge fireplace, bookcases were provided for either side of the fireplace, other donations included "coffee, sugar, shortening and other items so that cookies can be baked in plain sight and—smell—of boys that miss the home kitchen,--- coins for the juke box, records, ping pong table. "Articles needed included writing tables, 'sitting' chairs for our men and women guests, not those heartless things that are offered at the chamber of commerce meetings and in large part account for the poor attendance at the infrequent membership meetings."[2]

The EAGLES SHACK, coexisting with the Service Men's Club at the Adobe, was conceived at, "A meeting attended by nearly four score residents, representing nearly all active organizations of this community, was held Tuesday", Dec. 5, 1944, "evening in the Women's Club House…Judge J. M. Atkinson acting as temporary chairman explained the aims and objects of the project, giving it as his opinion, based upon much court dealings with youth, that supervised recreation is a big force in combating youthful delinquency."[3] By Dec. 11, 1944 "Saturday night at the Adobe was another indication of the interest the young folks of the community are taking in the matter of suitable recreation. ----- The following EAGLES SHACK Constitution has been drawn up and all participants must abide by it."[4] [4] Eagles Shack Constitution Articles I thru V are listed.

In early 1949 a four-page folder titled "The Eagle Shack" was published "dedicated to youth by youth."[5,6] About 2,800 copies of "The Eagle Shack" were distributed to principal towns in Northern California and recreation leaders in the state. ANYONE KNOWING OF A COPY of "The Eagle Shack" PLEASE NOTIFY the MVHA. The Eagles Shack or Eagle Shack, as MVUHS '49ers knew it, continued into the early 1950's. Around 1956 the Eagle Hut began meeting in the Sunnyview Club. Plans are afoot to bring the Eagle Shack back on May 6, 2007.

Drafted by Eugene Sharp, MVUHS Class of 1949, while drinking SPICA coffee at an outdoor table on the concrete steps covering what once was the Senior Lawn at MVUHS. The notes on 3x5 cards prepared by [redacted] Bobby Kinchen were invaluable to finding the referenced MV Register-Leader articles.

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[1] Mountain View Register-Leader Feb. 4, 1943, ADOBE BUILDING TO BE SERVICE MEN'S CENTER
[2] Mountain View Register-Leader Feb. 25, 1943, EVERYONE CAN HELP THE NEW SERVICEMEN'S CLUB
[3] Mountain View Register-Leader Dec. 7, 1944, YOUTH RECREACTION PLAN DISCUSSED AT MEETING
[4] Mountain View Register-Leader Dec. 11, 1944, ADOBE PROVES VALUE AS RECREATION CENTER
[5] Mountain View Register-Leader Feb. 6, 1949, Mountain View Teen Center Publicized in Attractive Folder
[6] Mountain View Register-Leader June 9, 1949, Eagles Shack Model For Teen Agers of The Entire State

Mountain View

Historical

Association

REGULAR MEETING

THE 1930 CENSUS

AS A MOUNTAIN VIEW

TIME CAPSULE

By Don McDonald

Sunday, 2/4/2007 @ 2pm

The Adobe Building

Moffett Blvd and

Central Expressway

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME:

ADDRESS:

TELEPHONE:

TYPE: NEW_____ RENEWAL_____

Regular Member $10/year
Family Membership $15/year
Life Member $200.00

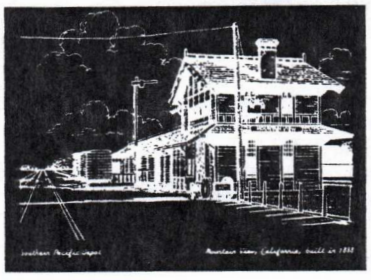
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